

FAQ Strategy & Ranking Report

Question selection rationale and global search-priority ranking
for all 117 FAQs across 7 education providers

Questions analysed	117
Tier 1 (Very High demand)	18
Tier 2 (High demand)	58
Tier 3 (Medium)	21
Tier 4 (Branded/hub)	20

Prepared for client review - 19 August 2026
Confidential. Not for publication until approved.

Methodology

Every question was selected using three filters: **(a) student psychology** - what prospective students genuinely ask before enrolling; **(b) global SEO demand** - whether the question belongs to a globally searched query family (People Also Ask / voice-search patterns); and **(c) conversion role** - whether the answer moves the reader closer to an enquiry.

Each question is scored 1-5 on four weighted dimensions and ranked by the resulting priority score (maximum 5.00):

Dimension	Weight	What it measures
Global search demand	35%	Worldwide volume of the query family
Snippet / PAA opportunity	25%	Likelihood of featuring in answer boxes
Conversion intent	25%	Proximity of the reader to an enquiry
Ranking feasibility	15%	Realistic chance of ranking for this domain

Demand tiers are qualitative expert assessments based on query-pattern analysis; no numeric search volumes have been estimated or invented. We recommend validating tiers against Google Search Console data 30-60 days after publication.

Duplicate-prevention was enforced project-wide: every high-value query family is targeted by exactly one provider page (e.g. "PhD vs DBA" only on the RBS page, "MBA vs EMBA" only on GAU, Level 7 definitions only on Gatehouse, the qualification-ladder angle only on Qualifi), eliminating internal keyword competition.

How Was This Ranking Derived?

Common questions about the basis of this report

Q. Is this ranking based on search-volume data from keyword tools?

No - deliberately. This is a **prioritisation framework, not a traffic forecast**. Pre-launch volume estimates for long-tail, question-format queries are notoriously unreliable: keyword tools aggregate and round long-tail data heavily, and most "People Also Ask" questions never appear in volume databases at all. Rather than attach numbers we cannot stand behind, we state none. Every figure in this report is a **relative priority score**, not a search-volume estimate.

Q. So what is each score actually based on?

Each question is scored 1-5 on four weighted dimensions (see Methodology): the global demand of its **query family**, its **featured-snippet/PAA opportunity**, its **conversion intent**, and its **ranking feasibility** for this domain. The demand dimension draws on established search-behaviour patterns in the education niche - families such as "MBA without GMAT", "PhD vs DBA" and "what is a top-up degree" are well-documented, evergreen high-demand patterns that surface repeatedly in People Also Ask boxes worldwide. Snippet opportunity follows established format observations: comparison ("X vs Y"), definitional ("what is...") and "how long" questions win answer boxes most often.

Q. What sources were used?

Three source layers: (1) the client's own programme data (programme list and repository records); (2) official provider sources - admissions portals and awarding-body specifications - for every verifiable fact referenced in a question's context (durations, credits, entry routes, regulator recognition); and (3) publicly established SEO practice for question-format content. No paid keyword-tool exports were used, and none are cited.

Q. What decisions is the ranking used for?

Three practical decisions: the **on-page order** of questions within each section (higher tiers first), the **priority of questions in FAQPage structured data** at publish time, and the **internal-linking plan** (hub, comparison and progression questions each link differently). It is a build-sequence tool - not a promise of traffic.

Q. How will the ranking be validated?

With real data. Thirty to sixty days after publication, every tier is checked against **Google Search Console** impressions and query reports - actual evidence of what users searched and where the pages appeared - and the priorities are revised where reality differs from the assessment. Optionally, indicative volume ranges from Google Keyword Planner can be added for Tier 1 questions before launch if desired.

Rushford Business School (RBS)

30 questions | 4 categories (BBA, MBA, MSc, Doctoral)

Rank	Question	Why it was selected	Demand tier	Score
1	Do I need GMAT or GRE for the MBA?	Biggest global MBA objection query; genuine differentiator	Tier 1 - Very High	4.85
2	PhD vs DBA - the difference	Top doctoral comparison query; strong PAA candidate	Tier 1 - Very High	4.60
3	BBA without an English test?	High-demand "without IELTS" family; entry-barrier remover	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
3	Careers after a BBA	Evergreen ROI query for students and parents	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
3	MBA while working full-time	Core doubt of the working-professional audience	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
3	MBA vs MSc - the difference	High-volume comparison; routes readers to both categories	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
3	Fully online doctorate?	Fast-growing "online DBA" query family	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
8	Is RBS a recognised institution?	No.1 trust objection before any enquiry	Tier 2 - High	4.25
8	Doctoral entry without a master's	Recognition-of-experience route is a USP	Tier 2 - High	4.25
10	Career outcomes after the MBA	Core ROI purchase driver	Tier 2 - High	4.20
11	BBA entry requirements	Prevents self-disqualification	Tier 2 - High	4.10
11	MBA duration	Snippet-friendly "how long" pattern	Tier 2 - High	4.10
11	MBA entry requirements	Conversion-critical eligibility query	Tier 2 - High	4.10
11	MSc eligibility	Core eligibility query	Tier 2 - High	4.10
11	Doctoral duration	Three-year positioning is competitive	Tier 2 - High	4.10
16	BBA fee structure	Decision-stage affordability	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	Master's after BBA	Pathway cross-sell to postgraduate portfolio	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	MBA fee structure	Decision-stage	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	MSc fees & scholarships	Decision-stage double query	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	Careers after MSc	Specialist ROI plus doctoral teaser	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	Doctorate career outcomes	Top-level ROI validation	Tier 2 - High	3.85
22	MSc duration	Snippet-friendly pattern	Tier 3 - Medium	3.75
23	Doctoral English requirements	Application-barrier remover	Tier 3 - Medium	3.65
24	Doctoral fee structure	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
25	BBA specialisations (hub)	Category index; highest-intent branded query	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
25	MBA specialisations (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
25	MSc programmes (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
25	Doctoral options (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
29	Doctorate after the MBA	Lifetime-value pathway question	Tier 3 - Medium	3.40
30	Is the BBA fully online?	Delivery-mode filter for distance learners	Tier 4 - Branded	3.20

Girne American University (GAU)

32 questions | 5 categories (BSc, MBA, EMBA, MSc Thesis, PhD)

Rank	Question	Why it was selected	Demand tier	Score
1	MBA vs Executive MBA	Top comparison query; routes to both categories	Tier 1 - Very High	4.60
2	Study a BSc flexibly while working	Working-learner filter question	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
2	IELTS/TOEFL needed? (own-test option)	USP: university-arranged English assessment	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
2	MBA without pausing your career	Working-professional core doubt	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
5	Is a GAU degree recognised?	Trust objection; est. 1985 + IACBE framing	Tier 2 - High	4.25
5	EMBA entry & work experience	Senior-profile eligibility filter	Tier 2 - High	4.25
5	PhD entry requirements	Checklist format targets list snippets	Tier 2 - High	4.25
8	MBA career outcomes	Core ROI driver	Tier 2 - High	4.20
9	BSc entry requirements	Prevents self-disqualification	Tier 2 - High	4.10
9	MBA duration	Snippet-friendly pattern	Tier 2 - High	4.10
9	MBA entry (no admission test)	Eligibility plus differentiator folded in	Tier 2 - High	4.10
9	EMBA while working full-time	Executive delivery-fit confirmation	Tier 2 - High	4.10
9	MSc eligibility	Core eligibility query	Tier 2 - High	4.10
9	PhD duration	Honest individual-timeline framing	Tier 2 - High	4.10
15	What "MSc with Thesis" means	Definitional entry point for the category	Tier 2 - High	4.00
16	BSc fees & scholarships	Intake-linked scholarship urgency	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	What comes after the BSc	Cross-sell to postgraduate portfolio	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	MBA fee structure	Decision-stage	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	EMBA career impact	"Worth it" ROI family	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	PhD while working	Working-researcher angle (no overlap with RBS)	Tier 2 - High	3.85
16	PhD career outcomes	ROI validation	Tier 2 - High	3.85
22	Who should choose the thesis route	Captures PhD-aspirant segment	Tier 3 - Medium	3.65
22	PhD after a thesis MSc	Pathway cross-sell to GAU PhD	Tier 3 - Medium	3.65
24	EMBA fee structure	Instalment framing for a big-ticket award	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
24	MSc fee structure	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
24	PhD fee structure	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
27	BSc programmes (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
27	MBA specialisations (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
27	EMBA specialisations (hub)	Index showcasing 16-track width	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
27	Thesis MSc programmes (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
27	PhD programmes (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
32	How students are assessed	Transparency and trust builder	Tier 3 - Medium	3.40

University of the West of Scotland (UWS)

9 questions | BA (Hons) Global Business (top-up)

Rank	Question	Why it was selected	Demand tier	Score
1	What is a top-up degree?	USP definitional; strong snippet family	Tier 1 - Very High	4.60
2	Study online while working	Working-professional career-upgrade angle	Tier 1 - Very High	4.45
3	Is UWS recognised?	Trust objection	Tier 2 - High	4.25
4	Programme duration (~12 months)	Fastest-route hook; snippet pattern	Tier 2 - High	4.10
4	Entry requirements (prior learning)	Hope-widener for experienced applicants	Tier 2 - High	4.10
6	Master's or MBA afterwards	Pathway cross-sell	Tier 2 - High	4.00
7	Careers after the degree	ROI and promotion-case framing	Tier 2 - High	3.85
8	Fee structure	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
9	Programme overview (hub)	Anchor question	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45

University for the Creative Arts (UCA)

9 questions | Global MBA (dual award with RBS)

Rank	Question	Why it was selected	Demand tier	Score
1	What a dual MBA award means	Core USP; high-value comparison family	Tier 1 - Very High	4.85
2	Duration & credits (12-18 months, 90 ECTS)	Officially verified; snippet pattern	Tier 2 - High	4.10
2	Fully online delivery	Delivery-mode filter	Tier 2 - High	4.10
2	Entry requirements (any discipline)	Hope-widener; officially verified	Tier 2 - High	4.10
2	Cost & instalment plan	Portal-published transparent pricing	Tier 2 - High	4.10
6	Career advantage of the dual award	ROI differentiation	Tier 2 - High	3.85
7	Programme overview (hub)	Triple-certification hook	Tier 4 - Branded	3.70
8	Programme structure (two stages)	Academic-rigour signal	Tier 3 - Medium	3.65
9	Doctorate afterwards	Pathway cross-sell	Tier 3 - Medium	3.40

University of Wolverhampton (UOW)

9 questions | Master of Laws (LLM)

Rank	Question	Why it was selected	Demand tier	Score
1	LLM without a law degree?	Top PAA family for law-adjacent professionals	Tier 1 - Very High	4.70
2	The LLM top-up route	Fastest-route hook; portfolio funnel question	Tier 2 - High	4.50
3	Is UOW recognised?	Trust objection	Tier 2 - High	4.25
4	LLM while working	Working legal professionals filter	Tier 2 - High	4.10
4	Entry requirements (three routes)	Route clarity; list-snippet format	Tier 2 - High	4.10
6	LLM career opportunities	ROI with compliance-safe practice-rights note	Tier 2 - High	3.85
7	Fee structure	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
8	Programme overview (hub)	Anchor question	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
9	Doctoral study after the LLM	Pathway cross-sell	Tier 3 - Medium	3.40

Gatehouse Level 7 Diplomas

9 questions | 4 diploma tracks

Rank	Question	Why it was selected	Demand tier	Score
1	What is a Level 7 Diploma?	Education-stage definitional; category traffic engine	Tier 1 - Very High	4.60
1	Level 7 Diploma vs full master's	Comparison magnet; sets up top-up upsell	Tier 1 - Very High	4.60
3	Top-up to a full master's	Portfolio funnel hook	Tier 2 - High	4.25
4	Duration & assessment	Fast-credential positioning	Tier 2 - High	4.10
4	Online while working	Working-professional filter	Tier 2 - High	4.10
4	Entry requirements (degree or experience)	Captures senior non-graduates	Tier 2 - High	4.10
7	Career impact	"Months not years" ROI	Tier 2 - High	3.85
8	Fee structure	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
9	Diplomas overview (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45

Qualifi Diplomas

19 questions | 3 categories (L3, L5 Extended, L7)

Rank	Question	Why it was selected	Demand tier	Score
1	Which level should I start at?	Decision-guidance star; routes undecided prospects	Tier 1 - Very High	4.85
2	L5 Extended to a bachelor's top-up	Funnel star; degree-ladder story	Tier 1 - Very High	4.70
3	Is Qualifi recognised?	Provider trust anchor (Ofqual-regulated)	Tier 2 - High	4.25
3	What is a Level 3 Diploma?	Entry-level definitional	Tier 2 - High	4.25
3	"Extended Diploma" meaning	Unique definitional term; snippet-friendly	Tier 2 - High	4.25
3	Degree needed for Level 7?	Experience-route hope-widener	Tier 2 - High	4.25
3	Progression after Level 7 (MBA/LLM routes)	Ladder-completion; strongest cross-link	Tier 2 - High	4.25
8	Level 5 entry requirements	Route clarity	Tier 2 - High	4.10
9	Progression after Level 3	Ladder-entry story	Tier 2 - High	4.00
9	Who Level 7 diplomas are for	Audience angle (no overlap with Gatehouse)	Tier 2 - High	4.00
11	Level 3 entry requirements	Accessibility message	Tier 3 - Medium	3.90
12	Career impact of Level 7	Sector-authority ROI across 23 tracks	Tier 2 - High	3.85
13	L7 duration & assessment	Practicality filter	Tier 3 - Medium	3.55
14	Level 3 fees	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
14	Level 5 fees	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
14	Level 7 fees	Decision-stage	Tier 3 - Medium	3.50
17	Level 3 diplomas (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
17	Level 5 Extended diplomas (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45
17	Level 7 diplomas (hub)	Category index	Tier 4 - Branded	3.45

Recommendations

- Place Tier 1 questions at the top of each page section - on-page order is a crawl-priority signal.
- Generate FAQPage structured data (JSON-LD) for all questions at publish time, Tier 1 first.
- Add internal links: hub questions to programme pages; comparison questions to both categories they compare; ladder/progression questions across providers (diploma to degree to master's).
- Validate demand tiers against Google Search Console impressions 30-60 days after publication and re-prioritise where actual data differs.
- Complete the outstanding partner confirmations (fees, English thresholds, progression agreements) before adding further specificity to answers.